

Medicare Bridge Criteria

Medicare GLP-1 Bridge

Starting July 1, 2026 to December 31, 2027, Medicare will begin a short-term demonstration, called the Medicare GLP-1 Bridge, that will provide **eligible Medicare Part D beneficiaries** with access to certain GLP-1 drugs. (Wegovy Injection and tablets, Zepbound, and Foundayo)

Clinical Criteria

- Lifestyle modification
- At least 18 years of age
- BMI greater than or equal to thirty-five (≥ 35) at the time of initiation of GLP-1 therapy
- BMI greater than or equal to thirty (≥ 30) at the time of initiating GLP-1 therapy with one or more of the following:
 - Heart failure with preserved ejection fraction
 - Uncontrolled hypertension (defined as systolic blood pressure above 140 mm Hg or diastolic blood pressure above 90 mm Hg, despite concurrent treatment with two antihypertensive medications)
 - Chronic kidney disease stage 3a or above
- BMI greater than or equal to twenty-seven (≥ 27) at the time of initiating GLP-1 therapy with one or more of the following:
 - Pre-diabetes (as defined by American Diabetes Association guidelines)
 - Previous myocardial infarction
 - Previous stroke
 - Symptomatic peripheral artery disease

The Medicare GLP-1 Bridge helps beneficiaries get GLP-1s when they are used only for weight loss or weight maintenance.

- If a beneficiary has type 2 diabetes, obstructive sleep apnea, or noncirrhotic metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH), they should get the GLP-1 through their Part D plan, not through the Medicare GLP-1 Bridge.
- The Medicare GLP-1 Bridge only covers GLP-1s for weight management, with a \$50 co-pay.
- If the GLP-1 is prescribed for a Part D-covered use, the beneficiary should continue using their Part D plan, regardless if it is approved or denied.

Prior Authorizations

— Due to the high volume of prior authorizations for GLP-1s, diabetic patients take priority and their PA requests will be completed first.

— PA requests can take up to 2 weeks to process, and our nursing staff works through them as quickly as possible.